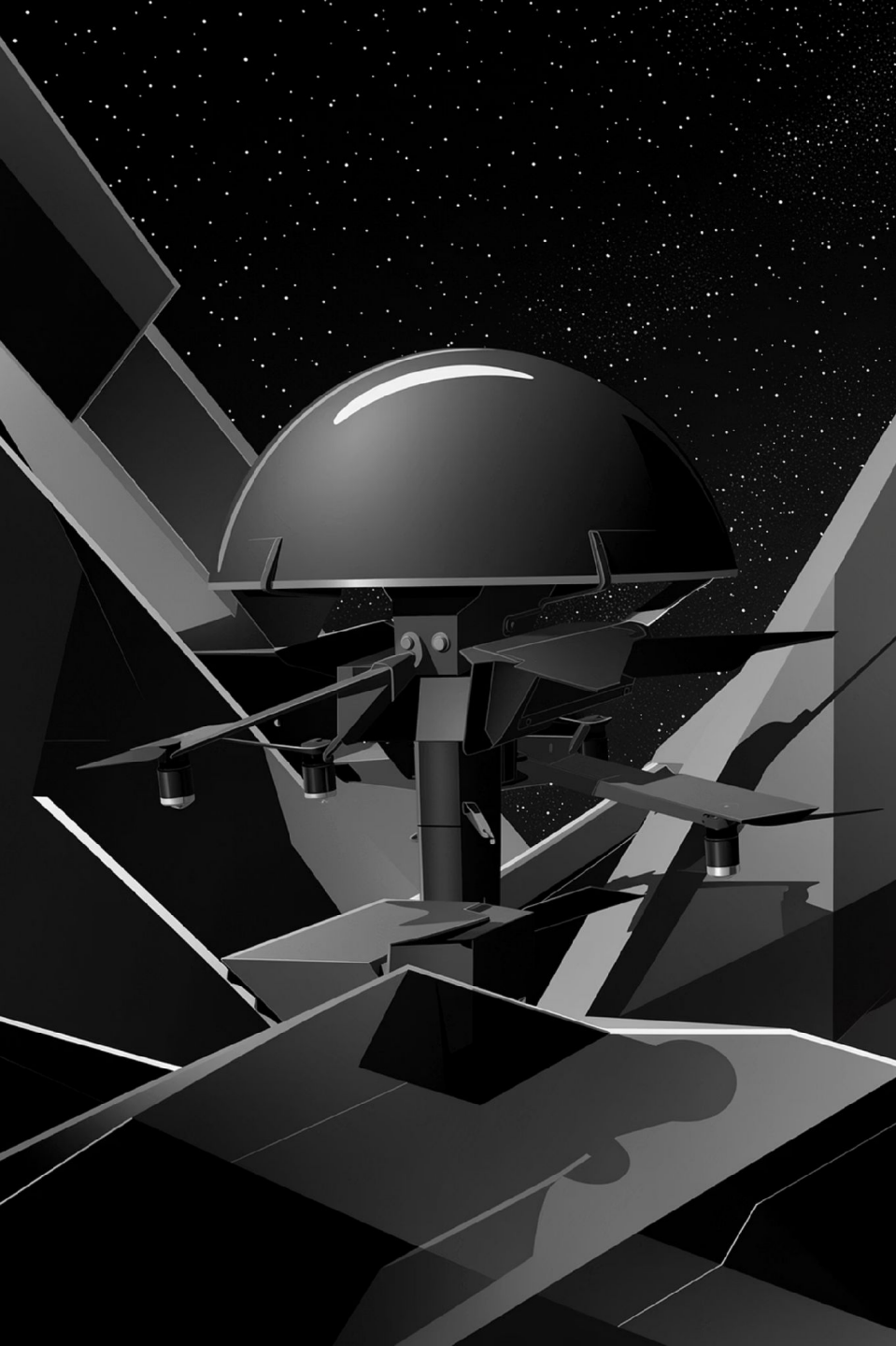




SDTH: 3-Month Track

Judge Scorecard

Demo week 21–27 Sep · Same three questions for every team. One scale, both tracks (**Little Red Dome + Neo-Battalion**). The target customer is the buyer – MINDEF/SAF; secondary: other NATO sovereign buyers.

① Does it work?

Demonstrated capability

40%

② Does the mission need it?

Operational fit

30%

③ Can it become real?

Team, economics, route to buyer

30%

① Does It Work?

Demonstrated capability the buyer / user could field. Depending on the system, functionality can be demonstrated with demo setups - for example, a physical intercept for an interceptor, or a sim result for a C2 agent.

1

Core Capability - Shown, Not Asserted

The system performs its primary function, demonstrated against a held-out / scripted scenario. We don't dictate the test site or format; teams propose how they prove it. Both live demos and video demos are accepted - e.g. for counter-drone, a recorded intercept, potentially at the Army drone centre (TBC).

2

Robustness - Against an Evolving Environment

Holds up as the threat and conditions change - jamming, GPS denial, comms loss, sensor dropout, clutter, night/weather are examples. Degrades gracefully; doesn't fail silently. Try to demonstrate part of these conditions in the demo.

3

Simplicity / Operability

Easy to operate; an operator can build a CONOPS (Concept of Operations) around it. Low training and integration burden. Present the operation as a short story where possible (5W1H).

4

Show-Stopper Risk

Are there major technical / operational risks that could become programme-killers? List these out up-front.

5

Integration / No Lock-In (MOSA)

Open, documented interfaces and standard data contracts so MINDEF / the SAF system owner can compose it in - a swappable node, not a sealed vertical stack. Sovereign control, no lock-in.

① Scoring Rubric: Does It Work?

5 - Excellent

Primary function shown convincingly, robust, simple to operate, cleanly integrable.

3 - Adequate

Works in the happy path, fragile or partly integrable

1 - Weak

Asserted, not shown



Red flags: cherry-picked single run · no open interfaces · sealed vertical stack with no MOSA compliance

② Does the Mission Need It?

Operational fit and framing - would the operators actually use it.

Need of today, or tomorrow - addresses a need today, or credibly where the threat is heading. Skating to where the puck is going, not only where it is. Is the system planned with a future threat in mind?



Real Operator Problem

Solves a real operator problem, sharply framed — not a solution chasing a need.



Genuine Capability Gap

Addresses a genuine capability gap, **not duplicating fielded kit**.



Singapore / SAF Context Fit

Terrain, threat picture, constraints - locally grounded.



Workflow / Doctrine Fit

An operator would actually use it in their workflow / doctrine.



Operator Contact Evidence

Evidence of operator contact - real SAF/agency end-users.



Scoped Honestly

Depth on one thing over a broad wish-list.



After the scoping already done on the problem sets, most teams should score well here.

② Scoring Rubric: Mission Need

5 - Excellent

An operator in the room would want it tomorrow

3 - Adequate

Plausible need, loosely framed

1 - Weak

Unclear who needs it



Red flags: generic problem · no operator contact · scope sprawl across too many use cases

③ Can It Become Real?

Team, economics, and a credible route to being incubated and fielded.

"Become real" = manufacturability for hardware, scale for software.

1

Team Archetypes

Team is on track to cover the three founder archetypes for defense :
operator + technical + commercial.

2

Build Velocity

What they actually shipped across the three months.

3

Cost & Manufacturability

Buildable at volume (hardware) · or scale economics (software).

4

Cost-Exchange Sense

For effectors, is price-per-shot sustainable vs. the threat?

5

Defensibility

Real moat / IP, or easily copied?

6

Route to Incubation & a Buyer / User

A credible on-ramp to being backed by DVL and bought by MINDEF/SAF.

③ Scoring Rubric: Can It Become Real?

5 - Excellent

Clear, affordable path to a fielded product the buyer would acquire, and a real company

3 - Adequate

Promising, gaps in team or economics

1 - Weak

No path past the demo



Consciously assess **commercial viability** - manufacturability, scale, route-to-market, defensibility - not only operational fit.

Red flags: solo founder · un-manufacturable · no identified buyer/user · no procurement on-ramp

Scorecard Summary

Same three questions for every team. Both tracks: Little Red Dome and Neo-Battalion.

Criterion	Weight	Scale
① Does it work?	40%	1 – 5
② Does the mission need it?	30%	1 – 5
③ Can it become real?	30%	1 – 5

- 📄 **Judge reminder:** Score all three criteria independently. For Criterion 3, consciously weight commercial viability - not only operational fit.